Case study: designing wellbeing that HR can prove

From a movement-break prototype to a pilot-ready B2B product, using research to close the gaps that make wellbeing tools fail.

Case study · Rupak Ghanpathi
Product · Business analysis

CONTEXT

Indian companies of 50–500 people offer wellbeing benefits, but the HR lead can't show they're used, and the founder approves spend. The prototype offered short guided movement sessions; the question was what would make HR buy and employees keep using it.

MY ROLE

Problem framing, research, requirements, product decisions, the HR-facing site and the pilot design, built and tested end to end.

WHAT THE RESEARCH SHOWED

~30%
of employees take part in company wellness programmes (Plum, 3,500+ Indian orgs, 2023)

~3%
of mental-health app users still active after 30 days (JMIR 2019, 93 apps)

Three people, three jobs: the employee wants a break that isn't homework; HR wants proof without surveillance; the founder wants a small, honest trial.

KEY DECISIONS, AND WHY

Decision	Rationale
Hide teams under 10, and a second team if subtraction could reveal one	Privacy as a product rule, not a policy; answers the distrust finding.
Fixed safety rules the AI can't override, in English and Hinglish	Eval: the word list alone missed 10 of 14 body concerns; adding the model missed none. Rules stay the floor.
Opt-in reminders on the employee's own calendar or Slack	Usage collapses without a trigger (~3% at day 30). No server, no tracking, "not today" costs nothing.
Team breaks at the end of meetings	Participation follows teams and managers; turns a private act into a team norm.
Targets agreed before day one, "Not met" shown openly	HR can't trust vendor ROI claims; an honest, falsifiable pilot is the differentiator.
Rebuilt the app from a workout companion into five office-safe desk breaks, seated or standing	People between calls choose by problem ("stiff neck"), not by training type; cardio and intervals don’t fit an office.
Free sample report as the first ask; pilot sized to one team	Budget is the top concern; the smallest yes starts the conversation.

WHAT I BUILT

- Two-sided demo (employee session beside the HR view) running the app's real rules.
- CEO slide with targets, need categories and cost per finished session; PNG export.
- Hosted app, launch kit, sample report, personalised links; 98 automated tests, all passing.

HOW SUCCESS IS MEASURED

- Outreach: qualified conversations per 10 sends; section reached; demo use.
- Pilot: tried, came back within a week, reminders set (leading indicator), "Lighter" answers.
- Status: pilot-stage; no customer results yet, by design reported plainly.

Pilot-stage product by Rupak Ghanpathi. All usage figures are sample data from a made-up 64-person company. Not a medical or mental-health service. Live: lull-hr.vercel.app · App: lull-hr.vercel.app/app · Code: github.com/RUPAK30/Sukoon-B2B-workplace-wellbeing-product-for-HR-teams